

8 Sales English Lines That Find the Real Objection

Eight lines for the moment a client objects. Most of the time the objection is about pricing, and most of the time the price is not what is actually stopping them. Each line has the reason it works and the weaker version it replaces.

The eight phrases

The same eight lines, now with the pronunciation and the reason each one works. Listen, then say each out loud.

1/8

That is a fair thing to raise.

/ðæt ɪz ə feə θɪŋ tuː reɪz/

TAKING THE OBJECTION SERIOUSLY

INSTEAD OF I understand, but the value is really there.

Why it works. The word but deletes everything in front of it. Agree first and they need not say it twice. Now you are both on one side of it.

That is a fair thing to raise, and I would want to know that too.

Tama lang pong banggitin ninyo iyan.

2/8

Can I ask what is behind that?

/kæn ai ɑːsk wɒt ɪz bɪ'haɪnd ðæt/

ASKING FOR THE REAL REASON

INSTEAD OF Why do you say that?

Why it works. An objection is a position, not a fact. Ask why, and they defend the position. Ask what is behind it, and they tell you the truth.

Can I ask what is behind that, before I answer it?

Maaari ko po bang itanong kung ano ang dahilan niyan?

3/8

Is that the main thing, or is there something else?

/ɪz ðæt ðə meɪn θɪŋ ɔː ɪz ðeə 'sʌmθɪŋ els/

SEPARATING ONE CONCERN FROM THE PILE

INSTEAD OF Is that your only concern?

Why it works. Only sounds like a test, so people say yes to end it. This makes a second worry easy to add. You need the second one.

Is that the main thing, or is there something else I should know?

Iyan po ba ang pangunahing bagay, o may iba pa?

4/8

So the part that worries you is the timing, not the price.

/səʊ ðə pɑ:t ðæt 'wɒrɪz ju: ɪz ðə 'taɪmɪŋ nɒt ðə praɪs/

SAYING THE CONCERN BACK IN YOUR OWN WORDS

INSTEAD OF Okay. I see.

Why it works. Timing and price are only an example. Name their two things, never yours. Say the worry back in your own words. Get it wrong and they will correct you.

So the part that worries you is the timing, not the price itself.

Kaya po ang inaalala ninyo ay ang timing, hindi ang presyo.

5/8

Can I give you a different way of looking at it?

/kæn aɪ gɪv ju: ə 'dɪfrənt weɪ ɒv 'lʊkɪŋ æt ɪt/

ASKING PERMISSION TO DISAGREE

INSTEAD OF Actually, that is not really true.

Why it works. You ask before you disagree. That makes it an offer, not an argument. Skip the question and they hear you calling them wrong.

Can I give you a different way of looking at it? Tell me if it helps.

Maaari po bang magbigay ako ng ibang pananaw dito?

6/8

Who else has to be comfortable with this?

/hu: els hæz tu: bi: 'kʌmfɪtəbəl wið ðɪs/

NAMING THE PERSON WHO IS NOT ON THE CALL

INSTEAD OF Are you the decision maker?

Why it works. Decision maker sounds like a test. People defend their job when tested. This asks about the other people, not their power. Usually the objection came from one of them.

Who else has to be comfortable with this before you can say yes?

Sino pa po ang kailangang maging komportable dito?

7/8

I would rather you told me now than in three months.

/aɪ wʊd 'rɔ:ðə ju: təʊld mi: naʊ ðæn ɪn θri: mʌnθs/

MAKING IT SAFE TO SAY NO

INSTEAD OF Are you sure? Just think about it.

Why it works. You make it safe to tell you the truth. A pushed client says maybe. Maybe costs you both more than a clear no.

I would rather you told me now than in three months, honestly.

Mas gusto ko pong sabihin ninyo sa akin ngayon kaysa sa tatlong buwan mula ngayon.

8/8

Does that answer it, or only part of it?

/dʌz ðæt 'ɑːnsə ɪt ɔː 'əʊnli pɑːt ɒv ɪt/

CHECKING YOU HAVE FINISHED THE JOB

INSTEAD OF Great. So we are good on price?

Why it works. That question asks for a yes and stops there. This one asks which half is still open. A half-answered objection comes back as silence.

Does that answer it, or only part of it?

Nasagot po ba niyan, o bahagi lang?

The steps

This is the sequence. It does not change.



Soften · Ask · Isolate · Check

When people feel heard, they tell you what is really in the way. When they feel handled, they say maybe.

Now you produce it

Write your answer first, then compare. Retrieving the phrase from a situation is what moves it into the language you can actually use under pressure. There is more than one right answer.

1. The client has just said your price is too high. Do not defend it yet.

That is a fair thing to raise.

The word but deletes everything in front of it. Agree first and they need not say it twice. Now you are both on one side of it.

2. You still have no idea what too expensive actually means to this client.

Can I ask what is behind that?

An objection is a position, not a fact. Ask why, and they defend the position. Ask what is behind it, and they tell you the truth.

3. Price is on the table. You suspect it is not the only thing on it.

Is that the main thing, or is there something else?

Only sounds like a test, so people say yes to end it. This makes a second worry easy to add. You need the second one.

4. They have described the worry in a long, tangled way. Say it back.

So the part that worries you is the timing, not the price.

Timing and price are only an example. Name their two things, never yours. Say the worry back in your own words. Get it wrong and they will correct you.

5. You can see they have the wrong idea about how the contract works.

Can I give you a different way of looking at it?

You ask before you disagree. That makes it an offer, not an argument. Skip the question and they hear you calling them wrong.

6. The objection did not come from the person you are talking to.

Who else has to be comfortable with this?

Decision maker sounds like a test. People defend their job when tested. This asks about the other people, not their power. Usually the objection came from one of them.

7. The call is drifting towards let me think about it.

I would rather you told me now than in three months.

You make it safe to tell you the truth. A pushed client says maybe. Maybe costs you both more than a clear no.

8. You have answered the price question. Do not assume you are finished.

Does that answer it, or only part of it?

That question asks for a yes and stops there. This one asks which half is still open. A half-answered objection comes back as silence.

Come back to this

Two situations, on the two days the research says matter. Say the phrase out loud before you look at the list again.

3/day **Day 3**

Three days ago you learned the four steps: soften, ask, isolate, check. New situation. There is no objection about money at all. The client has simply gone quiet since the demo and will not book the next call. Which of the four steps still applies, and which sentence would you open with?

7/day **Day 7**

One week in. This is the one people get wrong. The objection is aimed at you personally. They say the last supplier promised exactly the same thing and never did it. Two lines from this lesson still work here. Can you remember which, and why arguing about the last supplier loses the call?

